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■ The *Arthashastra* and the *Manusmriti* 35

Three rival philosophies developed during the Chinese Warring States period.

Confucianism:

People can be **taught to be good**. Rulers should govern by **virtue and tradition**.

Daoism:

People should live in **harmony** with nature and the universe. Rulers should **leave people alone**.

Legalism:

People are **self-interested**. Rulers should **deter crime and keep people in order** with punishments.

in honor of ancestors and gods; humaneness or fellow feeling (*ren*); and filial piety (*xiao*), the respect of children for their parents. Confucius argued that filial piety should be extended beyond the family to society as a whole. There were five key social relationships in which each individual had a proper place: ruler to subject, father to son, husband to wife, older brother to younger brother, and friend to friend. In each of these, the superior partner should be like a caring father, while the inferior should be respectful and obedient.

Confucius believed that laws and punishments were necessary only in a primitive society, where people did not observe the proper rites. If people were set a good example by those in authority and were educated, they would behave well. Confucius said, "To govern simply by law, and to create order by means of punishments, will make people try to avoid the punishment but have no sense

of shame. To govern by virtue, and create order by rites, will not only give them the sense of shame, but moreover they will become good."

Daoism

The key text of Daoism is the *Dao De Jing*, which is attributed to Laozi ("old master"), a possibly mythical teacher from the 6th century BCE. While the text may have been the work of more than one author, its central idea is that people should live in harmony with the natural order of the universe, called the Dao (Way). The *Dao De Jing* uses water as an example of what this means: "Water is fluid, soft, and yielding. But water will wear away rock, which is rigid and cannot yield. As a rule, whatever is fluid, soft, and yielding will overcome whatever is rigid and hard."

Daoists believed that all social problems would be solved if people lived a simple life and rid themselves of ambition and greed. They shared the Confucian distrust of laws. But unlike Confucians, who thought »



Confucius

Philosopher Kong Qui was born in 551 BCE, into the lower ranks of the nobility in the small eastern state of Lu. He was later known by his followers as Kong Fuzi ("Master Kong"), which led to his Western name Confucius. After spending years at the Lu court without gaining influence, he traveled from one state to another, hoping to persuade rulers to employ him as a minister. He failed to achieve office, as his ideas seemed idealistic and old-fashioned to the rulers of the time. Yet Confucius continued to spread his philosophy through teaching. His reputation for learning attracted many students, who came to him to study ancient ritual texts, such as the *Book of Rites* and the *Book of Songs*.

Although Confucius wrote no books, after his death in 479 BCE, his teachings were written down by his students in the *Lunyu* ("Conversations"), which is known in the West as the *Analects*.

Key work

c. 500 BCE *Analects*